Earl Hickson Jr.

Lead Front-End Engineer | Design Systems | Accessibility | Healthcare UI

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SUMMARY

Front-end engineer with a BFA in graphic design and 6+ years building production interfaces for healthcare, financial services, and digital media. At Asembia, took a fragmented set of HIPAA-regulated patient and prescriber portals from Bootstrap 3 to a reusable Bootstrap 5 component system, and got those standards adopted by the dev team. At BroadcastMed, led design and front-end delivery, mentored junior designers and developers, and built the email system that cut production time 25%. Outside client work, ships tested, CI-deployed products in React, Next.js, and TypeScript. Best where design, accessibility, and engineering overlap, and at getting a team to build the same way. A Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu black belt who has taught students of all ages since 2021; that coaching carries straight into mentoring engineers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Production (employer and client work): JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, SCSS/Sass, React, Vue.js, Bootstrap 3-5, REST APIs (GET/POST, JSON), Responsive and mobile-first UI, WCAG 2.1 AA, Cross-browser QA, Git, Bitbucket, CI/CD pipelines, .NET-hosted front ends, WordPress (custom PHP plugins), Wix CMS, Responsive HTML email

Shipped in independent products: TypeScript, Next.js (App Router, static export), Tailwind CSS, Vitest, React Testing Library, Zod, TanStack Query, Radix UI, Zustand, Node.js, Express, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Supabase, React Native (Expo), Socket.IO, GitHub Actions, Playwright, Vite

Design and UX: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign), Design tokens and component standards, Information architecture, Interaction design, Design-to-code handoff

Measurement and platforms: Google Analytics, Hotjar, Lighthouse, SEO, HubSpot, Salesforce Marketing Cloud, Zen Planner API

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Front-End Developer & Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Professor | AMA Fight Club

Cedar Knolls, NJ | Jan 2025 - Present

- Own the gym's website end to end: rebuilt it in Wix CMS with custom HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, with responsive layouts, simpler navigation, and SEO-ready structure.
- Integrated the Zen Planner API so website leads sync to the gym's membership CRM in real time, working through its authentication and submission requirements.
- Built mobile-first registration and lead forms, plus ZipRecruiter form integrations for recruiting campaigns.
- Lead the school's Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu program as a black-belt professor: teach youth and adult classes and lead the team at tournaments.
- Teach classes built on discipline and determination as much as technique, and push every student toward what they're capable of.

Independent Front-End Developer | Freelance and Contract

Remote | Nov 2024 - Oct 2025

Tabby's Place: A Cat Sanctuary | Front-End Developer, Contract | Oct 2025

- Designed and built a custom WordPress plugin from scratch for donation campaigns: live donation tracking, progress indicators, and adoptable-cat listings.
- Gave non-technical staff an admin screen to run campaigns without touching code, and delivered it from design to deployment on a compressed timeline.

Wealth Creation Innovation | Senior Front-End Developer, Contract | Nov - Dec 2024

- Built data-driven dashboard screens and reusable components in React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, and Stencil, wired to REST APIs.

Front-End Developer | Asembia

Florham Park, NJ | Dec 2023 - Oct 2024

- Took over a front end patched for years across several HIPAA-regulated portals (patient, provider, and a prescriber portal used by healthcare institutions) and set one standard for components, sizing, color, and brand tokens.
- Led the Bootstrap 3 to 5 migration and built a reusable component library during it.
- Presented the modernization approach to the CEO, won buy-in, and got the component standards adopted across the development team.
- Simplified dense prescription data tables for clinical users, which cut clarification requests from partner institutions.
- Integrated REST APIs (GET/POST) with the .NET backend team for prescription tracking and provider workflows, and brought key user journeys to WCAG 2.1 AA.
- Shipped through Bitbucket and CI/CD alongside UX, QA, and backend engineers, and introduced React into parts of the UI as the team moved toward a modern framework.

Lead Designer & Front-End Developer | BroadcastMed / Conexiant

Remote | Aug 2021 - Feb 2023

- Led design and front-end development of healthcare marketing microsites and landing pages in a proprietary CMS, turning stakeholder requests into shipped pages across concurrent projects.
- Raised lead-form submissions 18% by reworking layouts, call-to-action placement, and form flow based on Google Analytics and Hotjar data.
- Built a standardized HTML email system with reusable modules and design rules, cutting email production time 25%.
- Mentored junior designers and developers, and kept builds consistent across projects.
- Shipped responsive, cross-device pages inside a locked-down legacy CMS by adapting implementations to its constraints.

Front-End Developer, Contract | Prosek Partners

Remote | Apr 2021 - Sep 2021

- Built responsive landing pages and campaign interfaces in React, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, plus client projects in Vue.js.
- Implemented SEO and analytics tracking with mobile-first, accessible markup, working in Git with designers and account stakeholders.

Front-End Developer, Contract | William R. Seide Agency LLC

New Jersey | Jan 2020 - Jun 2020

- Built mobile-first sites for insurance and financial-services clients, improving form completion and cross-browser rendering.

Email Marketing Specialist, Contract | Merkle

Remote | Nov 2018 - Jul 2019

- Coded responsive HTML email for pharmaceutical campaigns, tested it across email clients, and held brand and accessibility standards.

Earlier: front-end and digital design roles at Kirshenbaum Bond Senecal + Partners and Second Melody, 2013-2017.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Gundam Forge | Deck Builder and Playtest Simulator | Beta

Next.js | React | TypeScript | Tailwind CSS | Supabase | Vitest | ehicksonjr.com/work/gundam-forge

- Built as a typed monorepo: a Next.js app plus shared packages for game rules and deck validation, a design system, and card-data sync.
- Maintains a 623-card catalog pulled from the official card site by a Playwright sync script and validated with Zod, with search, filters, and a validation engine that flags deck errors and warnings as you build.
- Playtester with a zone-based battlefield, 100-move undo/redo, keyboard shortcuts, and a computer opponent.
- 27 Vitest test files cover the rules engine, filters, API contracts, and replay storage; a GitHub Actions workflow gates every deploy on lint and build.

WithYou | Couples Communication App | In development

Expo React Native | TypeScript | Node.js | Express | PostgreSQL (Prisma) | Socket.IO | ehicksonjr.com/work/withyou

- Designed privacy-first: each person owns their profile, invite-code pairing links accounts without merging private data, and sharing is opt-in field by field.
- Private check-ins and real-time messaging over Socket.IO with reconnection handling; sensitive data kept in secure on-device storage.
- Defined the boundary for a planned AI mediator: it works only from privacy-filtered context and never exposes one partner's private data to the other.

DojoNet | Martial Arts Training and Community App | Prototype

React | Vite | Tailwind CSS | Zustand | Live demo | ehicksonjr.com/work/dojonet

- Training journal with session logging, technique progression, goals, and sparring stats, plus partner matchmaking with compatibility scoring and age-gated safety rules.
- Runs fully static on GitHub Pages with localStorage demo data; Express, Prisma, and Socket.IO server scaffolded for the full build.

COACHING AND LEADERSHIP

A Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu black belt, teaching youth and adult students since 2021. That coaching carries straight into mentoring engineers: progressive instruction, close observation, honest feedback, and adapting to how each person learns.

AMA Fight Club | Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Professor | Cedar Knolls, NJ | 2025 - Present

Colton Brown Training Center | Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Instructor | Warren, NJ | 2023 - 2024

Pure MMA | Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Instructor | Rockaway, NJ | 2021 - 2022

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Graphic Design | Kean University, Union, New Jersey | 2015

IBM Full Stack Software Developer Professional Certificate | IBM / Coursera | December 2025 | Verify

Full Stack JavaScript Certificate | Team Treehouse | 2022

Front-End Web Development Certificate | Team Treehouse | 2022